## 10.5 Working Class Strikes



Railroad Strike of 1877

The difficult working conditions in the factories, long hours of work, low wages, exploitation of women and children contributed to the growth of labour unions. After the Civil War, workers organized strikes. One major strike was the Great Railroad Strike of 1877. Wage cuts in the railroad industry, in the context of a prolonged economic depression, led to the strike, which began in West Virginia and spread to three additional states over a period of 45 days before being crushed by a combination of vigilantes, National Guardsmen, and Federal Army.

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### Haymarket Massacre

A labour protest took place on 4 May 1886, at Haymarket Square in Chicago. What began as a peaceful rally in support of workers striking for an eight-hour day resulted in the killing of several workers by the police. To commemorate the Haymarket Affair 1 May 1887 is observed as the Labour Day or May Day or International Worker's Day.



Haymarket Massacre

## 10.6 Important Inventions of the Industrial Revolution Era

| Inventions | Inventor | Year |
|---|---|---|
| Blast Furnace (Iron & Steel) | Abraham Darby | 1709 |
| Steam Engine | Thomas Newcomer | 1712 |
| Flying Shuttle (Textiles) | John Kay | 1733 |
| Improved Darby Process (Iron & Steel) | John Smeaton | 1760 |
| Spinning Jenny (Textiles) | James Hargreaves | 1764 |
| Spinning Frame (Waterframe) (Textiles) | Richard Arkwright | 1769 |
| Newcomen's Steam Engine Redesigned | James Watt | 1769 |
| Spinning Mule (Textiles) | Samuel Crompton | 1779 |
| Power Loom (Textiles) | Edmund Cartwright | 1785 |
| Cotton Gin (Textiles) | Eli Whitney | 1793 |
| Puffing Devil (the first steam powered locomotive) | Richard Trevithick | 1801 |
| Air Pump (in Mines) | John Bundle | 1807 |
| The Butcher (Locomotive) | George Stephenson | 1814 |
| Safety Lamp (for Mining) | Humphrey Davy | 1815 |



IX History 3rd Term_English version CHAPTER 10.indd 137 02-04-2019 13:04:35